JobSeek User Guide

JobSeek is a command-line tracker for job and internship applications. It tracks each application's company, role, completion status, and recruitment progress.

Quick start

1. Install Java 25 or later.
2. Download the latest `jobseek.jar` and place it in a folder where you have write permission.
3. Open a terminal in that folder and run `java -jar jobseek.jar`.
4. Enter a number from the menu and follow the prompts, or type a one-line command such as `add c/Google r/SWE Intern` (see Typed commands). Enter `0` or type `exit` to quit.

Note: Double-clicking the JAR may not open a usable terminal window. JobSeek needs write permission in the launch folder to create and update its data file.

Menu options

Number	Action	What it does
`1`	Add application	Enter a company, role and optional deadline. Company and role must be non-empty.
`2`	List applications	Show active applications with their original numbers and status.

`3`	List uncompleted applications	Show active applications with their original numbers.
`4`	Delete application	Enter an application number to remove it.
`5`	Mark application completed	Enter an application number to mark it complete.
`6`	Unmark application	Enter an application number to mark it incomplete.
`7`	Help	Show the menu options and command shortcuts.
`8`	Search applications	Find applications by company or role.
`9`	Sort applications	View applications alphabetically by company, then role.
`10`	Edit application	Update company, role, or recruitment stage of an application.
`0`	Exit	Quit JobSeek.

Typed commands (one-line shortcuts)

Instead of answering prompts one by one, you can type a whole command on one line. The numbered menu still works.

Action	Format	Example
Add	`add c/COMPANY r/ROLE [d/YYYY-MM-DD]`	`add c/Google r/SWE Intern d/2026-11-30`
Edit	`edit INDEX [c/COMPANY] [r/ROLE] [s/STAGE]`	`edit 2 r/Backend Intern s/Interview`
Delete	`delete INDEX`	`delete 3`

Mark / unmark	`mark INDEX`, `unmark INDEX`	`mark 1`
Search	`search KEYWORD`	`search google`
Find (combined filters)	`find [c/..] [r/..] [s/..] [b/..] [a/..] [m/..]`	`find c/google s/ interview`
Sort	`sort`	`sort`
List	`list [completed|all]`	`list all`
View details	`view INDEX`	`view 2`
Today dashboard	`today`	`today`
Undo	`undo`	`undo`
Help / exit	`help`, `exit`	`exit`

- `c/` is company, `r/` is role, `d/` is deadline and `s/` is recruitment stage (for example `Interview`, or the shortcut `OA`).
- Fields can be given in any order. In `add`, `c/` and `r/` are required. In `edit`, at least one field is required.
- Command words are not case-sensitive. `INDEX` is the number shown by `list`.
- A field value ends where the next `x/` prefix starts, so avoid typing text such as `r/` inside a company name.
- If a command is wrong, JobSeek shows what is wrong and the correct format, and nothing is changed.

Finding with combined filters: `find`

Narrows the list using several conditions at once. An application is shown only if it satisfies **every** filter you give.

- **Format**: `find [c/COMPANY] [r/ROLE] [s/STAGE] [b/DATE] [a/DATE] [m/yes|no]` (give at least one filter, in any order)

Filter	Meaning
`c/TEXT`	Company contains the text (ignores upper/lower case).
`r/TEXT`	Role contains the text (ignores upper/lower case).
`s/STAGE`	Recruitment stage equals `STAGE`, such as `Interview` or the shortcut `OA`.
`b/YYYY-MM-DD`	Deadline is on or before the date.
`a/YYYY-MM-DD`	Deadline is on or after the date.
`m/yes` or `m/no`	The application is (or is not) marked as completed.

Applications without a deadline never match `b/` or `a/`. Use both together to find a date range.

Examples:

- `find c/google s/interview` shows Google applications that are at the interview stage.
- `find r/intern a/2026-11-01 b/2026-11-30` shows internships with a deadline in November 2026.
- `find m/no s/offer` shows offers you have not marked as completed yet.

Results keep the numbers from the full list, so you can use them directly with `view`, `edit` and `delete`. If nothing matches, JobSeek says so and shows the conditions it searched for. `find` only displays results and never changes your data. For a quick single-word lookup, `search KEYWORD` is still available.

Adding an application

Choose `1` to create and track a new job or internship application.

- **Prompt sequence**:
    1. `Company:\n>` — Enter the name of the company or organization (e.g., `Google`, `Shopee`, `GovTech`).
    2. `Role:\n>` — Enter the title of the role or internship (e.g., `SWE Intern`, `Backend Engineer`, `Data Analyst`).
    3. `Deadline (YYYY-MM-DD, leave blank if none):` — Enter a deadline such as `2026-11-03`, or press Enter if no deadline is known. Invalid dates display an error and you will be prompted again.
- **Input validation**:
    - Both company and role are required fields and cannot be empty or whitespace-only.
    - If an empty input is submitted, JobSeek displays an error message (e.g., `Error: Company cannot be empty.`) and reprompts until a valid input is received.
    - Leading and trailing whitespace is automatically trimmed.
- **Initial attributes**:
    - The new application is assigned the next 1-based number in the list.
    - **Completion status**: Defaults to incomplete (`[ ]`).
    - **Recruitment stage**: Automatically initialized to `Applied`.
- **Confirmation message** (a `Deadline:` line is added when you entered a deadline):

```
Application added successfully.
Company: Google
Role: Software Engineering Intern
Deadline: 2026-11-30
```

- **Typed alternative**: `add c/Google r/Software Engineering Intern d/2026-11-30` does the same in one line.

Listing applications: `list`

Shows a table of tracked applications with their original list numbers, completion status (`[X]` or `[ ]`), company name, role title, and deadline.

By default, only active (uncompleted) applications are displayed.

Format: `list [completed|all]`

Menu shortcuts:

- Choose `2` to list active applications.
- Choose `3` to list uncompleted applications.

Examples:

- `list` – Shows active (uncompleted) applications.
- `list completed` – Shows only completed applications.
- `list all` – Shows all applications regardless of completion status.

Example output:

```
Here are your applications:
No. | Completed | Company   | Role            | Deadline
----+-----------+-----------+-----------------+-----------
1   | [ ]       | Google    | SWE Intern      | 2026-11-03
3   | [ ]       | Shopee    | Backend Intern  | -
```

> **Notes on list filtering:**
>
> - The `No.` column always displays each application's original 1-based index from the main list. You can safely use this index in commands such as `view`, `edit`, `delete`, or `mark`.
> - If no applications match the chosen filter, JobSeek displays an informative message:
>   - `No active applications found.`
>   - `No completed applications found.`
>   - `No applications found.`

Viewing application details: `view`

Displays a comprehensive, structured information card for a single job

application at the specified index. The card presents all recorded details including company, role, recruitment stage, and completion state.

Format: `view <application_number>`

Examples:

- `view 1` – Displays the detailed card for application number 1.
- `view 3` – Displays the detailed card for application number 3.

Example output:

```
==================================================
Application Details [Index: 1]
--------------------------------------------------
Company:   Google
Role:      SWE Intern
Recruitment stage: Accepted
Completed: No
==================================================
```

> **Notes on viewing applications:**
>
> - `<application_number>` must be a valid positive integer corresponding to an existing entry in your application list (e.g., `1`, `2`).
> - If `<application_number>` is missing, non-numeric, or `<= 0`, JobSeek notifies you: `Error: Please provide a valid positive application index. Usage: view INDEX`
> - If `<application_number>` is greater than the total number of applications, JobSeek displays: `Error: Application index X does not exist. (Total applications: Y)`

Editing an application

Choose `10` to update details of an existing application in place without deleting and recreating it.

- **Prompt sequence**:
    1. `Enter application index to edit:\n>` — Enter the 1-based index of the application to update (as displayed in `list`).
    2. `Enter field to edit (1: Company, 2: Role, 3: Recruitment stage, 4: All):\n>` — Select which field(s) you wish to modify:
        - `1`: Edit Company name only.
        - `2`: Edit Role title only.
        - `3`: Edit recruitment stage only.
        - `4`: Edit all three fields (Company, Role, and Recruitment stage).
    3. JobSeek will then prompt for the respective replacement value(s):
        - `Enter new company:\n>` (if editing company or all)
        - `Enter new role:\n>` (if editing role or all)
        - `Enter recruitment stage (1: Applied, 2: Online Assessment, 3: Interview, 4: Offer, 5: Accepted, 6: Rejected, 7: Withdrawn):\n>` (if editing the stage or all)
- **Input validation & error handling**:
    - If your application list is currently empty, JobSeek notifies you with `Error: Your application list is currently empty.` and returns to the menu.
    - Blank index input is rejected with `Error: Please specify a valid application index.`.
    - Non-numeric index input is rejected with `Error: Invalid application index. Please enter a valid number.`.
    - Out-of-bounds indices are rejected (`Error: Invalid application index: X. Please enter a number between 1 and Y.`).
    - Empty company or role values are rejected and reprompted.
    - Invalid stage choices are rejected and reprompted. Enter a stage name or its number.
    - Entering an invalid field choice (anything other than 1, 2, 3, or 4) displays `Error: Invalid field choice: '<choice>'. Enter 1, 2, 3, or 4.` and returns to the menu. Unedited fields preserve their current values and

completion flags (`[ ]` or `[X]`).

- **Typed alternative**: `edit INDEX [c/COMPANY] [r/ROLE] [s/STAGE]` changes only the fields you give, for example `edit 2 r/Backend Intern s/Interview`.
- **Confirmation message**: For field choices `1`, `2`, or `4` (Company, Role, or All):

```
Application updated successfully.
Company: Alphabet Inc.
Role: Senior SWE Intern
Recruitment stage: Applied
```

For field choice `3` (Recruitment stage only):

```
Application recruitment stage updated successfully.
Company: Alphabet Inc.
Role: Senior SWE Intern
Recruitment stage: Accepted
```

Recruitment stage tracking

Each application has one of these stages: `Applied`, `Online Assessment`, `Interview`, `Offer`, `Accepted`, `Rejected`, or `Withdrawn`. `Accepted`, `Rejected`, and `Withdrawn` are terminal stages. You can still edit a stage at any time to correct a mistake or reflect a company process; stages do not enforce a fixed transition order.

Updating a stage

Under menu option `10`, select field `3` (Recruitment stage) or `4` (All). Enter one of the numbered choices shown by the prompt, or type a stage name such as `Interview`. The shortcut `OA` is also accepted for `Online Assessment`. Inputs are case-insensitive. You can also type `edit INDEX s/STAGE`, for example `edit 1 s/oa`.

Inspecting an application stage

Use the `view INDEX` command to view the comprehensive card for any application, including its recruitment stage:

```
view 1
==================================================
Application Details [Index: 1]
--------------------------------------------------
Company:   Google
Role:      SWE Intern
Recruitment stage: Accepted
Completed: No
==================================================
```

Search and sort applications

Search applications

Choose `8`, then enter part of a company name or role. Search ignores letter case. For example, `eng` matches both `Engineer` in a role and `Engineering Co` in a company name. An empty search term is rejected and you will be prompted again. If nothing matches, JobSeek tells you so.

You can also type `search KEYWORD` (for example `search eng`) or, to combine several conditions, `find` (see Finding with combined filters).

Search results show the same application numbers as the normal list. For example, if the matching record is application `3`, you can still enter `3` when marking or deleting it. Search does not change or save application order.

Sort applications alphabetically

Choose `9` or type `sort` to view applications ordered by company name, then by role when company names match. Sorting ignores letter case. The number beside each application is its original number in the normal list. This is a display-only view: it does not rearrange the saved applications. If you later type `list all`, the original order is shown again.

Deleting an application

Choose `4` to remove an application. JobSeek asks you to confirm first, and you can reverse the deletion with `undo`.

1. Enter `list all` to find the number of the application you want to delete.
2. Enter `4` at the main menu.
3. Enter the application number when prompted. (Or type `delete INDEX`, for example `delete 2`, to skip the prompt for the number.)
4. JobSeek shows the application and asks `Delete ... ? (y/n)`. Enter `y` or `yes` to delete it. Any other answer cancels the deletion and nothing changes.

For example, entering `2` at the deletion prompt and `y` at the confirmation prompt removes application number `2`.

Application numbers after the deleted entry shift down by one, so check the list again before deleting another application.

If the list is empty or the application number is invalid, JobSeek displays an error without deleting anything.

Undoing a change: `undo`

Reverses the most recent change to your applications, such as an accidental deletion.

- **Usage**: Enter `undo` at the main menu prompt.

- **What can be undone**: adding, deleting, editing a recruitment stage, and marking or unmarking an application.
- Enter `undo` again to step further back, newest change first.
- Commands that only display information (`list`, `view`, `search`, `today`) and cancelled or failed commands are not recorded.
- The history is kept in memory only, so it is cleared when you exit JobSeek.
- If there is nothing to undo, JobSeek shows `Nothing to undo.`.

```
> undo
____________________________________________________________
Undone: deleted [ ] Google | SWE Intern
____________________________________________________________
```

Marking an application as completed: `mark`

Marks the application at the specified index as completed (`[X]`). Completed applications represent concluded application pipelines (such as accepted offers or finalized cycles) and are hidden from the default active list view to keep your workspace clutter-free.

Format: Choose `5` from the menu, then enter `<application_number>`, or type `mark <application_number>`.

Examples:

- Choose `5`, then enter `1` – Marks application number 1 as completed.
- `mark 1` – Does the same in one line.

Example output:

```
Nice! I've marked this application as completed:
  [X] Google | SWE Intern
```

> **Notes on marking applications:**

- If your application list is currently empty, JobSeek notifies you: `Error: Your application list is currently empty.`
- If the entered index is blank, non-numeric, or out of range, JobSeek rejects it with an error:
  - `Error: Please specify a valid application index.`
  - `Error: Invalid application index. Please enter a valid number.`

Unmarking an application: `unmark`

Reverts the completion status of the application at the specified index back to incomplete (`[ ]`). The application is reactivated and will appear in active application listings.

Format: Choose `6` from the menu, then enter `<application_number>`, or type `unmark <application_number>`.

Examples:

- Choose `6`, then enter `1` – Reverts application number 1 back to incomplete.
- `unmark 1` – Does the same in one line.

Example output:

```
OK, I've marked this application as not completed yet:
  [ ] Google | SWE Intern
```

Notes on unmarking applications:

- If your application list is currently empty, JobSeek notifies you: `Error: Your application list is currently empty.`
- If the entered index is blank, non-numeric, or out of range, JobSeek rejects it with an error:

- `Error: Please specify a valid application index.`
- `Error: Invalid application index. Please enter a valid number.`

Deadline warnings

JobSeek automatically checks deadlines when it starts and displays warnings before the main menu.

Warning	Meaning
`OVERDUE`	The deadline is earlier than today.
`DUE TODAY`	The deadline is today.
`UPCOMING`	The deadline is within the next seven days, including exactly seven days away.

Only applications that have not been marked as completed are included. Applications without deadlines do not produce warnings.

For example, if today is `2026-10-28`, the following warnings may appear:

```
Deadline warnings:
OVERDUE: Google - SWE Intern (deadline 2026-10-27)
DUE TODAY: Shopee - Backend Intern (deadline 2026-10-28)
UPCOMING: GovTech - Data Analyst (deadline 2026-11-03)
```

If no applications require attention, no warning summary appears. Warnings are checked once at startup and do not automatically refresh while JobSeek remains open. To see the same information at any time, use the `today` dashboard.

Today dashboard: `today`

Shows what needs your attention right now, without restarting JobSeek.

- **Usage**: Enter `today` at the main menu prompt.
- **Sections**: `OVERDUE`, `DUE TODAY` and `UPCOMING` (deadlines within the next seven days), followed by a `SUMMARY` of active and completed applications and a count of active applications per recruitment stage.
- Only applications that are not marked as completed appear in the deadline sections. Each entry keeps the number you use with `view`, `edit` and `delete`.

```
Today: 2026-10-28

OVERDUE (1)
  1. Google | SWE Intern - 2026-10-27 (1 day overdue)

DUE TODAY (0)
  none

UPCOMING (next 7 days) (1)
  3. GovTech | Analyst - 2026-11-04 (in 7 days)

SUMMARY
  3 active, 1 completed, 1 active without a deadline
  Active by recruitment stage - Accepted: 1, Applied: 2
```

Data

JobSeek automatically saves application data to `data/applications.txt` when commands modify application records. Saved records are loaded when you next start JobSeek.

- Company, role, completion status, optional deadline and recruitment stage are preserved between sessions.
- Data files saved by older versions still load. Missing stages and legacy `Pending` values become `Applied`.

- If the data file does not exist, JobSeek starts with an empty application list.
- **Corrupted-line recovery**: If any line in the data file is corrupted (e.g., malformed format, invalid boolean flag, invalid deadline, or empty required field), JobSeek displays an informative warning, skips the corrupted record, and successfully loads all remaining valid records.
- If loading completely fails due to an unrecoverable system I/O error, JobSeek displays an error and starts with an empty list.
- `search`, `find`, `sort`, `list`, `view`, `today` and `help` only display information and do not modify saved data.
- `undo` history is not saved: it is cleared when you exit JobSeek.

The data file location is relative to the folder from which you launch JobSeek. Launch the application from the same folder each time to access the same saved records.

Help instructions

Choose `7` to view the comprehensive reference of all menu options and textual command shortcuts.

- **Usage**: Enter `7` at the main menu prompt.
- **Output**:

```
Available menu options:
  list [completed|all]            - List active, comp
  undo                            - Undo the last add
  add c/COMPANY r/ROLE [d/DATE]   - Add an applicatio
  edit INDEX [c/..] [r/..] [s/..] - Edit company, rol
  delete|mark|unmark INDEX        - Delete, complete
  find c/.. r/.. s/.. b/.. a/..   - Combine filters
  search KEYWORD | sort           - Search by company
  today                           - Show overdue, due
  view INDEX                      - View details for
  [1] Add application             - Add a new interns
  [2] List applications           - View active appli
```

```
[3] List uncompleted apps       - View active / unc
[4] Delete application          - Delete an applica
[5] Mark application completed  - Mark an applicati
[6] Unmark application          - Mark an applicati
[7] Help                        - Show this help me
[8] Search applications         - Find applications
[9] Sort applications           - View applications
[10] Edit application           - Edit an existing
[0] Exit                        - Exit JobSeek
```

Command Summary

Action	Format	Examples / Usage
Add application	`1` or `add c/COMPANY r/ROLE [d/DATE]`	Choose `1`, or `add c/Google r/SWE Intern d/2026-11-30`
List active applications	`list` or `2` or `3`	`list` or choose `2` or `3`
List completed applications	`list completed`	`list completed`
List all applications	`list all`	`list all`
View application details	`view <application_number>`	`view 1`
Delete application	`4` or `delete INDEX`	Choose `4`, or `delete 2`; then confirm with `y`

Undo last change	`undo`	`undo`
Mark application completed	`5` or `mark INDEX`	Choose `5`, then enter application index (e.g. `1`), or `mark 1`
Unmark application	`6` or `unmark INDEX`	Choose `6`, then enter application index (e.g. `1`), or `unmark 1`
Today dashboard	`today`	`today`
Help instructions	`7` or `help`	`7` or `help`
Search applications	`8` or `search KEYWORD`	Choose `8`, then enter search term (e.g. `Google`), or `search google`
Find with combined filters	`find [c/..] [r/..] [s/..] [b/..] [a/..] [m/yes|no]`	`find c/google s/interview`
Sort applications	`9` or `sort`	Choose `9`, or `sort`, to view applications alphabetically
Edit application	`10` or `edit INDEX [c/..] [r/..] [s/..]`	Choose `10`, or `edit 2 s/Interview`
Exit JobSeek	`0` or `exit`	`0` or `exit`